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Ocala National Forest - Prospectus for Campground and Related Granger-Thye Concessions (Marina)

Question and Answers

Posted (5/9/2025)

Version 2 (5/6/2025)

Questions:

3. Would the FS contact the concessionaire for release of the annual electricity cost information for both the Recreation Area and the Marina?

A: Per the prospectus, *Section I., F. Utilities and Waste Management*, "Applicants should contact current service providers to obtain *estimated* costs for the utilities."

The average estimated utility costs for the Salt Springs Recreation Area are:

Electricity: \$63,000.00

Water and Sewage: \$20,000.00

Waste Disposal: \$50,000.00

4. Is the (marina) site on city water?

A: Per the prospectus, *Section I., F. Utilities and Waste Management, Water*, the marina's water is provided by Marion County Utility Authority. It is on a separate meter that is fed from the well, currently maintained by Marion County, located at the Salt Springs Recreation area.

5. Are the toilets a vault or flush system (at the marina)?

A: Located in the prospectus, *Section I., C. Description of Developed Recreation Sites and Facilities*, the toilets at the marina are a flush system.

6. Is the restroom on city sewer?

A: The restroom is connected to an on site septic system. Per the prospectus *Section I., F. Utilities and Waste Management, Liquid/Solid Waste Disposal*, the permit holder is responsible for maintaining.

7. What is the max parking capacity?

A: Listed in the prospectus in *Section II., J. Day Use Capacity*, currently, the maximum is about 50 vehicles. It can potentially accommodate a few more, but it depends on how close visitors park since the site does not have defined parking spaces.



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8. Are there restrictions on what can be rented from the concessionaire?

A: There are currently no restrictions. Please keep in mind that the Salt Springs Run is a designated manatee habitat, so high powered boat engines would have an extreme negative impact.

9. What is the eelgrass restoration project for?

A: Currently, Salt Springs' springs and sections of the Salt Springs Run are bare of eelgrass, which is a vital source of food for manatees. It is important for the health of the springs as the plant converts nutrients in the water, releases oxygen in the water, and stabilizes the sand. As a designated manatee habitat, it is important to be a good steward to try and improve the springs so future generations may get to enjoy the manatees, as well as enjoy swimming in the springs and fishing in the run.

10. How long is the eelgrass restoration project going to take?

A: There is not an estimated time range. Currently, the project is showing good signs, as the plants grow outside of the installed protective cages. There are many factors that could positively or even negatively impact the restoration project.

11. Is the fence along the shore at the marina structural?

A: The fence is not structural. The fence is in place to deter visitors from approaching portions of the shoreline, which causes instability and eventual erosion of the shoreline.

12. Does the water at the artisan well get tested? Who is responsible for testing that source?

A: Currently, the water at the artisan well is not tested. It is currently listed as non-potable. Should testing become necessary in the future, the concessionaire would be responsible for testing the water, per the Special Use Permit language, *Appendix 10*.

13. Is the boat slip rental rate set by the concessionaire? Would it be included in the reported revenue?

A: Per the prospectus *Section II., L. Fees Charged to the Public*, the boat slip rental rate is set by the concessionaire.

The rates are presented to the Forest Service, and the concessionaire and Forest Service together agree on appropriate rates and fees. All fees collected from the public are reportable and are required to be documented in the reported revenue.

14. Where do the kayaks and canoes launch from at the marina?

A: Kayaks and canoes launch from the aluminum docks at the marina.



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15. Has there been any dredging recently at the Marina?

A: There has not been any dredging at the marina within the past 5 years.

16. Who would be responsible for dredging if it is needed?

A: If a dredging project is needed to be done and depending on the urgency of completion, the Forest Service may be the responsible party to complete the dredging. However, the concessionaire may opt to be responsible for the dredging to be included as a Granger Thye project.

Please see *Section II., C. Granger-Thye Fee Offset Agreement* for more information on Granger-Thye (GT) agreements.

17. How is the overflow parking handled?

A: Currently, the overflow parking is inside the gated area where the boat slip is. Parking is not permitted along Highway 19, nor in local businesses' parking lots without written approval obtained by any local property owners. The new permit holder can propose a parking plan to the Forest Service to discuss accommodating more vehicles.

18. Is there possibility for the parking to expand?

A: Per the prospectus, *Section II., J. Day Use Capacity*, the new permit holder can propose a parking plan to the Forest Service to discuss accommodating more vehicles. The Forest Service would like to work with the concessionaire to come to solutions for parking and overflow parking before a permanent expansion of the parking lot is considered.

Posted (3/24/2025)

Version 1 (3/20/2025)

1. Question: The deadline for submitting questions for the campground's solicitation is April 4, 2025, before the site visit. Interested parties may have questions regarding things observed during the site visit.

A: The Forest Service has extended the deadline for submittal of questions to April 30, 2025. Additionally, prospective applicants will have an opportunity to ask questions during the site visit. All questions and answers will be posted to Sam.gov

2. The site visit is only two weeks prior to application deadline. With printing and shipping times considered, this will only give applicants about one week to prepare after the site visit.



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A: The Forest Service has extended the application deadline to May 30, 2025.